

Cohort B – APR Initiative Alignment

Program/Degree	Assessment Year	Program Learning Outcomes/Student Learning Outcomes	Assessment Finding/Concern	Analysis of Assessment Results	Improvement Action Taken	Results of Improvement Action
Computer Information Technology AAS/TC	2021-2022	PLO 5- Demonstrate skill and knowledge in preparation for industry-recognized certification examinations.	Assessment results identified a need to strengthen students' technical skills and preparation for industry-standard IT certifications. Certification results indicated that additional hands-on practice and instructor-supported preparation could better support student achievement.	Faculty determined that students would benefit from additional hands-on lab time outside regularly scheduled classes to reinforce technical skills and prepare for CompTIA and Cisco certification examinations. The curriculum had already been redesigned to align with industry certifications and employer-identified skills, making additional applied practice an important component of student preparation.	Scheduled and promoted optional, instructor-supported on-campus lab sessions outside regular class time in selected Cisco CCNA, CompTIA A+, and CompTIA Network+ courses. The additional lab time provided students with hands-on practice and preparation for industry certification exams and SkillsUSA competitions.	Additional on-campus lab support was implemented in 15% of CITC courses within the AAS curriculum, including selected Cisco CCNA, CompTIA A+, and CompTIA Network+ courses. Two full-time faculty provided additional lab sessions beyond regularly scheduled classes. Future PLO 5 and industry certification results will be reviewed to determine whether the additional hands-on support improves student achievement and certification readiness.
Health Sciences AAS	2021-2022	PLO 1- Describe health care organizations from the perspective of key stakeholders.	Assessment results showed generally strong student achievement; however, variability in certification and registry outcomes identified a need to further strengthen students' foundational understanding of medical terminology and physiological systems.	Faculty determined that students could benefit from additional instruction connecting medical terminology and physiological systems to their application in health care professions. Providing content from the perspective of health sciences professionals was identified as a strategy to reinforce foundational knowledge and better prepare students to apply these concepts in subsequent clinical coursework.	Collaborated with Health Sciences program directors to develop short videos addressing physiological systems and medical terminology for inclusion in the AHC 115 eLearn course. The videos were designed to provide students with an additional approach to learning terminology through real-world health care perspectives.	The initiative established a goal for at least 50% of Health Sciences programs to contribute videos addressing medical terminology and physiological systems for use in AHC 115. The videos provide students with additional discipline-specific learning resources to reinforce foundational concepts. Subsequent PLO 1 and certification/registry results will be reviewed to determine whether the additional instructional resources support more consistent student achievement and certification readiness.

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Ophthalmic Technician AAS	2021-2022	PLO 1- Graduates will utilize and apply their knowledge of ophthalmic technology to solve problems in a clinical setting.	Certification exam results showed strong overall student performance; however, the contact lens section was identified as an area needing additional attention. The findings indicated an opportunity to strengthen students' application of clinical knowledge and math-based problem-solving skills related to contact lenses.	Faculty analyzed certification exam performance and identified contact lenses as a content area for targeted reinforcement. Because competency in this area requires students to apply clinical concepts and mathematical calculations, faculty determined that focused assessment and instruction could strengthen student performance and certification readiness.	Faculty reviewed and assessed student performance in the contact lens content area and provided targeted reinforcement of contact lens concepts and related clinical and mathematical skills, with the goal of improving performance on the contact lens section of the Certified Ophthalmic Technician (COT) examination.	COT Exam Performance Reports for 2021–2022, 2022–2023, and 2023–2024 showed that VSCC students achieved higher mean scores in the contact lens content area than students from all other ophthalmic training programs. The sustained results across three assessment years provide evidence of strong student achievement in the area originally identified for improvement.
Sleep Diagnostic Technology TC	2021-2022	PLO 2- Students will become competent polysomnographic technologists with training in the fundamentals of polysomnographic technology, laboratory fundamentals, and clinical skills as outlined in, but not limited to, the Association of Polysomnographic Technologists Curriculum Outline.	Assessment identified a need to strengthen students' understanding of polysomnographic instruments and ancillary equipment, including how equipment functions and when and why it is used.	Faculty determined that students needed a more structured approach to learning essential equipment concepts. A targeted list of concepts and a rubric in PSG 120C were developed to provide clearer expectations and strengthen assessment of students' understanding of polysomnographic instruments and ancillary equipment.	Developed and implemented a targeted list of electrical and ancillary equipment concepts and a new rubric in PSG 120C to strengthen students' understanding of polysomnographic instruments and supporting equipment.	Faculty reported that the initiative worked well and observed improved student retention of important equipment concepts; however, specific assessment data were not collected to quantify the improvement. Based on faculty review, the activity will continue with modifications for future cohorts, including use of a group grade. Future PLO 2 assessment data should be collected to determine and document the effectiveness of the intervention.
Dental Assisting TC	2021-2022	PLO 2- Students will define the terminology unique to dental assisting.	Assessment results identified the continued need to reinforce students' understanding and accurate use of terminology unique to dental assisting. Strengthening terminology knowledge is important to effective communication and application of skills in the clinical environment.	Faculty review of student learning and clinical assessment results indicated generally strong performance but identified dental terminology as an area requiring continued reinforcement. Faculty determined that maintaining focused instruction and assessment of terminology would support students' ability to communicate accurately and apply appropriate terminology in clinical settings.	Continued to reinforce and assess dental assisting terminology across courses with the goal of increasing achievement of PLO 2: Students will recognize terminology unique to dental assisting.	PLO 2 results showed sustained student achievement, with approximately 80-90% of students meeting competency benchmarks across courses. The results indicate continued strength in students' knowledge of dental assisting terminology. Faculty will continue to assess PLO 2 and refine instructional, and assessment practices as needed to maintain or improve student achievement.

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Humanities and Fine Arts General Education Review (GER)	2021-2022	GE Outcome 4- Create or interpret artifacts of expression, as performer or as critic, through the development of skills of performance or skills of analysis and criticism. GE Outcome 6- Effectively convey ideas and arguments with attention to several of the following; relevance, completeness, clarity, coherence, consistency, or persuasiveness.	Assessment results showed stronger student achievement in interpreting themes and cultural relationships, while comparative synthesis and higher-level analysis were identified as areas needing improvement.	Faculty determined that students needed additional opportunities to practice comparative and analytical skills before completing major writing assignments. The review also identified a need for more consistent assessment across literature and film courses using a shared rubric to strengthen the reliability of General Education assessment results.	Expanded the shared assessment approach to include literature courses, including ENGL 2045, and the film course, ENGL 2860. Faculty also incorporated earlier, low-stakes comparative activities to provide students with additional practice before major writing assignments.	A more consistent assessment approach has been established across literature and film courses, and additional comparative learning activities have been incorporated to address the identified weaknesses in GELO 4 and GELO 6. Course success remained strong; however, direct reassessment data demonstrating improvement in GELO 4 and GELO 6 were not identified. Future General Education assessment results will be used to determine whether these changes improve students' comparative synthesis and higher-level analytical skills.
Natural Sciences General Education Review (GER)	2021-2022	GE Outcome 1- Conduct an experiment, collect and analyze data, and interpret results in a laboratory setting. GE Outcome 2- Analyze, evaluate, and test a scientific hypothesis. GE Outcome 3- Use basic scientific language and processes and be able to distinguish between scientific and non-scientific explanations. GE Outcome 4- Identify unifying principles and repeatable patterns in nature, the values of natural diversity, and apply them to problems or issues of a scientific nature.	Review of assessment practices identified inconsistent coverage of the four TBR Natural Sciences learning outcomes. While 76% of General Education science courses assessed some outcomes, only 38% assessed all four, limiting the department's ability to consistently evaluate student achievement across the curriculum.	Faculty determined that more consistent assessment across General Education science courses and sections was needed to produce sufficient evidence of student learning and support meaningful analysis of GELO achievement. COVID-19 disruptions also affected assessment consistency. Faculty established goals of 100% of General Education science courses and 80% of course sections assessing all four TBR learning outcomes.	Every general education science course will assess all four TBR learning outcomes. Currently, 76% of our general education courses are assessing some of the outcomes. 38% are assessing all four outcomes. We are setting a goal of 100% compliance in science courses, and 80% compliance in course sections.	Assessment processes were strengthened through the development of tools aligned with all four TBR learning outcomes, increasing the program's capacity to consistently measure student learning. Faculty review determined that some assessment tools require additional refinement to improve the quality and consistency of future assessment data. Subsequent General Education assessment cycles will be used to evaluate progress toward the 100% course-level and 80% section-level assessment goals and provide more comprehensive evidence of student achievement across GELOs 1-4.

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Social Behavioral Science General Education Review (GER)	2021-2022	GE Outcome 1- Recognize, describe and explain social institutions, structures and processes occurring within a complex global and diverse society. GE Outcome 2- Think critically about how individuals are influenced by social institutions in their own and other diverse cultures. GE Outcome 3- Investigate the relationship between individuals and societies as it affects personal behaviors, social development and quality of life of individuals, families and communities. GE Outcome 4- Examine the impact of behavioral and social scientific research on major contemporary issues and their disciplines effects on individuals and society. GE Outcome 5- Gather analyze and present research data perceptively and objectively using appropriate principles, methods, and technologies for the purpose of drawing logical conclusions on human behavior. GE Outcome 6- Evaluate ethical implications in the social and behavioral sciences. GE Outcome 7- Analyze and communicate the values and processes that are used to formulate theories regarding the social context of individual human behavior in the social and behavioral sciences.	Assessment results showed that most Social and Behavioral Science courses met the established 70% proficiency benchmark; however, Geography assessment results identified areas where student achievement remained below the benchmark and required additional instructional attention	Assessment results show most courses met the 70% proficiency benchmark across PLOs 1-7, with targeted instructional adjustments in Economics and Geography leading to measurable gains, and the department will standardize writing-based assessments and expand high-impact assignments to strengthen alignment and improve the reliability of future General Education assessment results.	Increased the use of high-impact assignments and structured discussions in Geography courses to strengthen student engagement, application of course concepts, and achievement of General Education learning outcomes.	Faculty implemented additional high-impact assignments and structured discussions in Geography courses and observed increased student participation and engagement. However, subsequent assessment results showed that the 70% mastery benchmark was not met. Faculty will continue to review the assessment results and refine instructional strategies to address areas of lower achievement and improve student performance in future General Education assessment cycles.
Teaching AST	2021-2022	PLO 3- Develop a lesson plan including the alignment of curriculum standards, educational outcomes, and adaptations for disabilities, predominant theorists, and assessment.	Praxis Core Math performance was identified as an area for continued improvement to ensure teacher candidates demonstrate the quantitative knowledge and skills needed for successful progression and licensure readiness.	Praxis Core Math scores increased steadily from 156.5 to 176.3, demonstrating that early practice testing and targeted support improve student performance. Continuing these strategies strengthens candidates' quantitative skills, supports licensure readiness, and improves overall student learning.	Continued early Praxis practice testing and targeted preparation and support for students, with the goal of increasing Praxis Core for Educators Math scores and strengthening achievement of PLO 3.	Spring and Fall 2023 Praxis Core Math results showed a mean score of 162, exceeding the required passing score of 150. These results demonstrate achievement above the established external benchmark. Faculty will continue Praxis preparation and monitoring to support sustained PLO 3 achievement and candidate licensure readiness.

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Early Childhood Education TC	2021-2022	PLO 2- Students will demonstrate and understanding of family relationships, child development, developmentally appropriate practice, observation and assessments, learning environment, health and safety, guidance, and orientation to professionalism in the field of early childhood education.	Assessment results identified declines in several student learning outcomes, including students' application of professional knowledge and communication skills. Faculty identified a need to strengthen students' understanding and application of ethical standards and professional guidelines in early childhood education.	Faculty determined that students needed additional reinforcement and opportunities to apply ethical standards and professional expectations to early childhood practice. The transition to asynchronous online instruction also identified a need for additional faculty support to help students successfully engage with course content and assignments.	Strengthened instruction and assessment related to ethical standards and professional guidelines. In Fall 2024, the program also added Zoom seminars to provide additional support for students enrolled in asynchronous online courses.	In Spring 2024, 9 of 15 students completed the PLO-related assignment, and all students who completed the assignment earned a score of 90% or higher. While the results demonstrate strong achievement among students who completed the assessment, the 60% completion rate identified a need for continued attention to student participation. Zoom seminars were added in Fall 2024 to provide additional support for asynchronous students. Subsequent PLO 2 results will be reviewed to determine whether achievement and assessment completion improve.